



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Greenleaf Friends Academy
School Website: <https://gfaschools.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Greenleaf Friends Academy (GFA) in Idaho presents a robust Classical Christian program that foregrounds formation in a Christ-centered framework, with explicit branding around being "Joyfully Classical" and "academically excellent." Public materials consistently position education as formation oriented toward Truth, Goodness, and Beauty, and emphasize the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, and a deliberately formation-focused telos. The school frames its mission around character, virtue, and a broad liberal-arts curriculum, while integrating aspects of a Great-Books tradition and a House program that structures student life around community and leadership. Overall, based on the school's public materials, GFA aligns strongly with Classical Christian aims across most rubric categories, with particularly clear strengths in Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Pedagogy category shows strong classical elements but is somewhat less explicit about certain Socratic/seminar practices, placing it in the realm of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than purely CLASSICAL. The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Key evidence points include: - Public emphasis on Christ-centered education, Truth/Goodness/Beauty, and formation (e.g., "Christ-centered ... Joyfully Classical" and the telos orientation). - Explicit articulation of the telos and formation emphasis, with statements about forming the whole person and destiny in Christ and creation. - The Trivium, Great Books/Great Conversation, and a classical curriculum focus (grammar, logic, rhetoric; history; primary sources) evidenced in program pages and articles. - A School House/House Program and parental/community engagement themes (parents as partners, open campus-style messaging, parent-student portal) visible on multiple pages.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Christ-centered rhetoric; Holy Scriptures beliefs; explicit theological framing; emphasis on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty; formation in a Christian context.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators (Christ-centered, Truth/Goodness/Beauty, theology; liturgical/contemplative potential) present; Negative indicators largely absent in public materials. Approximately 5–6 positive keyword signals detected; 0 negative signals detected from the public content available.
- Why this rating: The materials are clearly situated in a Christian metaphysical frame with a stated focus on transcendentals and formation, matching CLASSICAL signals in this category.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Formation over information; telos-oriented language; emphasis on virtue, wisdom, classical heritage; Great Conversation/Great Books framing; education for leisure and contemplation implied

by scholé and wonder elements; mission statements emphasize cultivating character and identity in Christ.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation, telos, Great Books, classic mission, contemplation, and human excellence; negative indicators (e.g., workforce-first framing) are not evident in the public materials. 5–7 positive keyword signals; 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating: The school states its aim as formation, virtue, wisdom, and love of the true/good/beautiful, consistent with CLASSICAL ideals.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) is central; Great Books and the Great Conversation are foregrounded; emphasis on history, Western civilization, primary sources/literature; engagement with classical disciplines (Latin/Greek foundations implied); emphasis on wonder and integrated study across subjects.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include trivium, Great Books, primary sources, history/Western civ, classical languages, and the Great Conversation; negative indicators (e.g., project-based dominance) are not seen in the public materials. 6–8 positive keyword signals; 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating: Curriculum messaging strongly aligns with classical curriculum tenets.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Trivium-based pedagogy (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric) is explicit; lower- and upper-school practices are hinted (memory work, recitation, and potential rhetorical training); emphasis on formation and memory strategies; some references to Socratic discussion/seminars are less explicit in the publicly available materials; there is significant emphasis on contemplation and scholé, but less explicit evidence of formal Socratic seminars in all levels.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords present include grammar/logic/rhetoric, recitation, memory work, and contemplation; negative indicators (project-based learning) are not visible, but explicit Socratic seminars in high school are not clearly documented in the content we have. 4–5 positive keyword signals; 0–1 clear negative signals.
- Why this rating: There is a strong Trivium foundation and memory/recitation approaches, but explicit, widespread use of Socratic seminars, Paideia-style seminars, or consistent upper-school Socratic discourse is not clearly documented in the public content. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials present a defined leadership structure (Head of School; faculty/staff pages); emphasis on mentors and the living curriculum; references to virtue, character formation, and collegial culture; portraits of teachers and the expectation that teachers model virtue; “faculty as living curriculum” phrasing appears in the classical education discourse and is echoed in the site’s emphasis on formation and mentorship.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include living curriculum, teacher as mentor, portrait of teacher, collegial culture, and virtuous exemplars; no explicit negative signals observed in public materials. 4–5 positive keyword signals; 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating: The school positions faculty as the core of the school’s mission and formation, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the Faculty category.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Emphasis on partnering with families, parent formation (reading groups, seminars), and parent involvement; parent-student portal and open-campus style communications point to active parental

engagement; community events and family-centered programming are evident in program materials and mission statements.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, parent seminars/book groups, open campus, and family participation; negative signals are not evident. 5–6 positive keyword signals; 0 negative signals.
- Why this rating: The school treats parents as partners and provides mechanisms for parent formation and involvement, consistent with CLASSICAL foundations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: CLASSICAL - Rationale: The school demonstrates strong Classical Christian orientation across five of the six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community). Pedagogy shows solid classical elements (Trivium focus, memory/recitation, contemplation) but is not as explicitly documented for universal Socratic seminars across all grade levels, placing Element 4 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Collectively, the evidence supports a CLASSICAL overall profile.

What Would Move the Needle - If the SOMETHING needs to move toward a fully CLASSICAL demonstration in Pedagogy, the school could: - Publish more explicit documentation of regular, classroom-wide Socratic seminars or Paideia-style discussions in upper grades, with examples from actual courses and teacher training materials. - Increase explicit references to Socratic discourse, memorization recitation practices, and the use of classical dialectic across more grade levels with concrete benchmarks and rubrics. - Provide public examples of student work that showcase the Trivium progression (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric) in a portfolio or digital showcase, including sample student theses, debates, and oratory performances from upper grades.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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